Salimar M. Salomabao

Salimar Manking Salomabao is a Maranao Muslim banking executive and community leader who has dedicated over three decades to reshaping the financial future of Overseas Filipino Workers in the Middle East.

As Senior Assistant Vice President and Region Head of the Middle East at Philippine National Bank, he stands as the primary architect of PNB's remittance and cross-border payment operations across one of the world's most critical corridors for Filipino economic empowerment.

His signature legacy is rooted in a simple but transformative belief: that banking is not merely about moving money, but about nation-building and personal liberation.

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Lead

Salimar Manking Salomabao embodies the intersection of heritage and purpose. A proud Maranao Filipino Muslim descended from Sultan Manking Sugador, the first Sultan of Tamparan, he carries a legacy of leadership that manifests not in titles alone, but in direct impact on the lives of over 2.1 million Filipinos across the Gulf Cooperation Council region.

His career trajectory from Saudi Arabia to the United Arab Emirates to his current position at Philippine National Bank reveals a man shaped by the struggles of OFWs and determined to translate that empathy into financial systems that work for ordinary Filipinos.

His most enduring achievement is not a transaction volume or an earnings report, but a movement: transforming workers into investors through systematic financial literacy advocacy across the GCC, creating pathways for hundreds of Filipinos to secure meaningful employment, and positioning PNB as the undisputed financial bridge between diaspora and homeland.

Heritage and Family Legacy

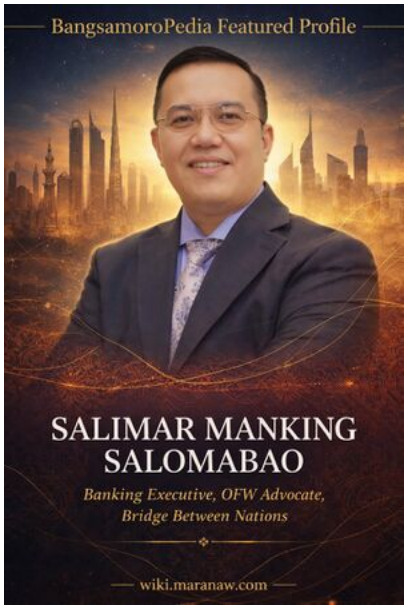
Salimar Manking Salomabao hails from a lineage of considerable historical and cultural weight in Lanao del Sur.

His roots span the municipalities of Tamparan, Lumba Bayabao, and Taraka, grounded in the legacy of Sultan Manking Sugador, who established the Sultanate of Tamparan and set the cultural foundation for Maranao leadership.

He is the son of the late Salomabao Bano and Haja Raisah Mamayamban Manking Liawao.

Through his paternal line, he descends directly from Sultan Manking Sugador; through his maternal heritage, he connects to Liawao Mokamad, the late Datu a Cabugatan of Masiu.

This dual lineage anchors his understanding of public service and institutional responsibility, values that would define his professional trajectory.



Salimar Manking Salomabao	
Position	Senior Assistant Vice President, General Manager and Region Head, Middle East
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Nationality	Filipino
Education	Bachelor of Science in Accountancy Manuel L. Quezon University (1993)
Occupation	Banking Executive, Community Leader
Years Active	30+ years
Organization	Philippine National Bank
Known For	Financial literacy advocacy for Overseas Filipino Workers, OFW empowerment, cross-border remittance innovation
Awards	Pioneer Award for Excellence in Banking Leadership Asia's Empowered International Leader Award Global Filipino Icon Award

Education

Salimar Manking Salomabao began his formal education at Malungun Taraka for elementary school before pursuing secondary studies at Mindanao State University in Tamparan.

Recognizing the need to broaden his professional prospects, he relocated to Manila and enrolled at Manuel L. Quezon University, where he earned his Bachelor of Science in Commerce with a major in Accountancy in 1993.

The rigorous foundation in accounting and financial analysis provided the technical toolkit necessary for his subsequent ascent into international banking.

Career in International Finance

Early Years in Saudi Arabia

Salimar Manking Salomabao's international banking career began in Saudi Arabia, where he joined Al Rajhi Bank, one of the world's largest Islamic banking institutions.

In his initial role as Senior Marketing Officer, he demonstrated an unusual gift for navigating complex financial markets and understanding the distinct needs of expatriate workers.

This early exposure to Islamic banking principles and the mechanics of remittance flows would become the foundation for his future work in cross-border finance.

Arab National Bank Era

In 2001, Salomabao transitioned to Arab National Bank (ANB), where he spent sixteen formative years as Remittance Manager.

This was the crucial period of his career, where specialized expertise in cross-border payments, regulatory compliance, and the logistics of moving capital across continents became his professional identity.

During his tenure at ANB, he oversaw the seamless flow of capital for thousands of expatriates, ensuring that the hard-earned money of overseas workers reached their families in the Philippines and across the Muslim world with security and efficiency.

The work was not glamorous, but it was essential: every transaction represented a family's investment in a child's education, a home, a business, or a dignified retirement.

Philippine National Bank and Current Role

In 2017, Salimar Manking Salomabao joined Philippine National Bank, assuming the position of Senior Assistant Vice President.

His rapid ascent to Region Head and General Manager for the Middle East reflected both his track record and the strategic importance PNB placed on the Middle Eastern market.

In this capacity, he oversees the bank's entire business footprint across one of the world's most dynamic economic regions: from the financial hubs of Riyadh and Dubai to the emerging markets of Muscat and Manama.

His mandate is clear: ensure that PNB remains not just a financial intermediary, but the trusted bridge between the Global Filipino and the homeland.

Financial Literacy Advocacy

Beyond boardrooms and balance sheets, Salimar Manking Salomabao built a parallel career as a crusader for financial education.

He has dedicated a significant portion of his professional life to addressing a fundamental problem: most OFWs, despite earning substantial incomes, lack the knowledge to build wealth systematically.

His advocacy operates on a deceptively simple principle: the transition from "spender" to "investor."

Through targeted financial literacy programs conducted across the GCC region, specifically in Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, and Oman, he has empowered thousands of individuals to move beyond living paycheck to paycheck.

He emphasizes investment in real estate, educational assets, and small business ventures as pathways toward sustainable wealth creation.

His approach combines the rigor of banking with the compassion of someone who understands the sacrifices that OFWs endure.

> I believe that banking is more than just a series of transactions; it is a tool for nation-building and personal liberation.

Community Leadership and Human Capital Development

Salimar Manking Salomabao's influence extends well beyond finance.

He has been instrumental in facilitating employment opportunities for hundreds of Filipinos across the GCC region, leveraging his professional network and institutional knowledge to open doors that might otherwise remain closed.

Whether in the bustling hubs of Dubai and Riyadh or the developing economic corridors of Muscat and Manama, he has positioned himself as an active broker of opportunity.

His community leadership roles reflect this commitment:

He serves as President of the Tamparan Islamic Development Association in Riyadh, an organization focused on preserving Maranao cultural identity while addressing the socio-economic needs of the diaspora community.

He holds a directorship position at Filicom in the United Arab Emirates, where he advocates for Filipino business interests and cross-cultural commerce.

He serves as a trusted Adviser to the Maranao Community in the UAE, offering guidance on matters ranging from family welfare to cultural preservation to economic empowerment.

Recognition and Awards

Salimar Manking Salomabao's contributions to the banking industry and the Filipino community have earned recognition through multiple prestigious accolades:

The Pioneer Award for Excellence in Banking Leadership acknowledges his foundational work in establishing new standards for remittance efficiency and customer care in the international banking sector.

Asia's Empowered International Leader Award recognizes his role in advancing not just his institution, but the broader cause of Filipino economic dignity in Asia's most critical markets.

The Global Filipino Icon Award celebrates his embodiment of the values that define the diaspora at its best: hard work, cultural pride, a commitment to community, and an unwavering belief in Filipino potential.

Legacy and Impact

Salimar Manking Salomabao occupies a singular position in the history of Filipino financial services.

He arrived in international banking at a time when OFWs were often treated as transactional entities, their remittances managed by systems indifferent to their aspirations.

He leaves behind a legacy of institutional practice and personal example that treats each transaction as sacred, each client as a builder of nations, each remittance as an act of hope.

His ongoing work at Philippine National Bank continues this mission: ensuring that the 2.1 million Filipinos in the Middle East have access to financial systems that respect their dignity, protect their assets, and empower their families.

Further Reading

- "Banking and the Global Filipino: New Frontiers in Cross-Border Finance"
- "Financial Literacy for Overseas Workers: Best Practices from the GCC"
- "The Maranao Diaspora: Leadership, Community, and Cultural Preservation in the Middle East"

See Also

- Philippine National Bank
- Overseas Filipino Workers
- Maranao people
- Islamic banking in the Middle East
- Bangsamoro heritage and diaspora

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